

From: Davis, Carla C.

To: Adams, Kay M.; Brown, Nadyne T.; Moore-Painter, Sankey R.; Carlin, Cindy T.; Check, Madonna S.; Denny, Theresa B.; Fullton, Rebecca H.; Hicks, Andrea C.; Hutchins, Cindy W.; Jacovec, Joanne M.; Lentz, Clay S.; Roggenkamp, Joan B.; Ruff, Jimi T.; Rzotkiewicz, David; Watson, Dennis A.; Williams, George D.; Bellis, Andrea L. (Andi); Brewer, Lee-Ann; Broom, Kay B.; Buckner, Janet W.; Carrick, Diane D.; Church, Lois; Cornett, Rick R.; Crim, Mary Ruth; Cullip, Anne H.; Draper, Dot C.; Gaillard, Ralph C.; Gomez, Ray T.; Gordy, Cathy L.; Grout, Ronald B.; Hale, Marianne; Hatter, Bruce D.; Haynes, Linda B.; Haynes, Marty L.; Hicks, Susan R.; Huffstetler, Sherry; Jennette, Winton; Joyner, Gwen B.; Kiger, Mandie V.; Martin, Diana J.; McAtee, Ed M.; McLaurin, Jacqueline M.; Nicks, Geraldine M.; O'Connor, Lori M.; Premo, Kathryn A.; Preston, Martha H.; Reid, Sharon G.; Richardson, Kevin; Settle, Pam B.; Shaw, Mike W.; Smith, Myra; Spencer, Jasper D.; Stewart, Ann T.; Wadia, K.N.; Williams, Karen J.; Williard, Linda F.; Blakley, Robin D.; McGill, Nancy H.; Carter, Peggy C.; McMillian, Barbara N.; Letourneau, Paul A. <KAM>

CC:

BCC:

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Attachments:

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Addendum to FSC-89-B		10/10/97	
SUBJECT: Second Half 1997 Wholesale Partners Program Category 1 - 3¢ Payment (Jul/Aug/Sep)			
DISTRIBUTION:			
<u>X</u> AVP	<u>X</u> KAM	<u>X</u> DM	
<u>X</u> RSM	<u>X</u> AM	<u>X</u> RM	
<u>X</u> RBM	<u>X</u> AE	_____ Sales Rep	
<u>X</u> ROM		_____ Retail Rep	

Objective: Communicate Third Quarter Payment Approval Process for the 1997 Wholesale Partners Program (July/August/September).

Rationale: Payments will be issued to Direct Accounts that meet Third Quarter, Category 1 data reporting requirements.

Automatic Payment Approval:

The Automatic Payment Approval process is in effect for the Category 1 - 3¢ volume payment for Third Quarter 1997. Under this process, accounts that are not considered "Exception" Accounts or "New" Accounts will be *automatically* approved in the Partners Tracking System **October 20, 1997**.

This procedure reduces the administrative time required by Field Sales to approve Partners payments.

Direct Accounts will qualify for Automatic Payment Approval if

- A minimum of 10 weeks of data is passed to the Partners Tracking System.
- The reported volume does not exceed the 105% tolerance allowance for purchases during current quarter (July/August/September) or previous quarter (April/May/June).
- The Account was approved for final payment during the previous program period (January - July 1997).
- The Account is not involved in an unresolved audit situation.

Manual Payment Approval:

The Direct Accounts that do not meet the criteria for automatic payment will require Field Sales Managers to determine if payment should be made (this includes all NEW Plan A/G participants). These accounts can be identified through the (T36) Report Function in the Partners Tracking System beginning **October 21, 1997**.

If it is determined an account should be approved for payment and the payment has not been automatically approved, the Account must be manually approved for payment through the (T35) Account Maintenance Function in the Partners Tracking System during the week beginning Monday, **October 27, 1997 - October 31, 1997**.

If these Accounts are not approved for payment by **October 31, 1997**, they will not be paid. The ROU should confirm that all Accounts not automatically approved for payment are reviewed and approved, as applicable, by the **October 31, 1997** deadline. An account's approval status can be tracked using the (T36) Report Function referred to above.

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General Payment Information:

To be considered for third quarter 3¢ volume payment (13 week period between June 29 - September 28), an account must have submitted a minimum of 10 weeks of valid data to MSA by October 1, 1997. Data resolutions, including resubmission's for First Quarter must have been completed by October 9, 1997.

The program participants that are approved for the 3¢ volume payment can expect to receive their payments on or around **November 17, 1997**.

ROU Program Contacts: Kathryn Noxon, extension #2559
Julie Knabb, extension #7754

R. J. REYNOLDS TOBACCO COMPANY

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